

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called 'She Who Is Golden'

Ārya Kāñcanavatī Nāma Dhāraṇī · Toh 633 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་གསེ་ཅན་ཞེས་བརྒྱུན་གྱི་མཛུགས།

Toh 633 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in English as "The Noble Dhāraṇī Called She Who Is Golden," in Sanskrit as the Ārya Kāñcanavatī Nāma Dhāraṇī, and in Tibetan as Phakpa Serchen Zhejawa'i Zung. It belongs to the dhāraṇī section of the Kangyur, a class of texts centered on the transmission of protective or empowering mantra formulas. The text is framed as a discourse given by the Buddha in response to Śakra, the lord of gods, who appeals for divine protection against the magical powers — illusions, knowledge-mantras, secret mantras, and medicines — wielded by the asuras in battle. As is typical of dhāraṇī sūtras, this narrative setting provides the occasion for the Buddha to bestow a powerful dhāraṇī intended to offer refuge and safeguarding to those who invoke it.

In the language of India: Ārya Kāñcanavatī Nāma Dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "She Who Is Golden."

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling together with Vajrapāṇi, the great lord of the yakṣas, in a place like the sky. Then Śakra (Indra, king of the gods), the lord of gods, went to where the Blessed One was, and having arrived, he bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One and sat down to one side. Having sat to one side, Śakra, lord of gods, addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, do you know that when I go to battle and engage in combat, I am defeated by the illusions, the knowledge-mantras, the secret mantras, and the medicines of the asuras? Blessed One, please take us under your care, show compassion toward us, and well teach the great secret mantra of the great victory — that which thoroughly destroys and utterly annihilates the illusions, the knowledge-mantras, the secret mantras, and the medicines of the asuras — and by whose defeat we may triumph completely."

Then the Blessed One spoke to Śakra, lord of gods, saying: "Kauśika, so it is. When battling the asuras, you are indeed defeated by their knowledge-mantras, their secret mantras, and their medicines — so it is. Kauśika, out of compassion I will now recite the knowledge-mantra: that which routs all illusions, repels all knowledge-mantras, routs all secret mantras, and

utterly pacifies all combat, all strife, all provocation, all fighting, and all warfare; the knowledge-mantra that cuts through all secret mantras and medicines — this I shall now explain."

Thereupon the Blessed One at that moment proclaimed the great knowledge-mantra, the Golden One. He declared: "For three immeasurable eons I was ill-wished and obstructed by the tīrthikas (non-Buddhist adherents) — wanderers and the naked ones — yet from that time until now I, having repelled all the knowledge-mantras of those with illusions, fully perfected the six perfections. This great knowledge — which utterly destroys the illusions, the knowledge-mantras, the secret mantras, the medicines, and all the hordes of māra belonging to the tīrthikas, the wanderers, the naked ones, and the violent — this I have now declared. Kauśika, in order that you may take all sentient beings under your care, receive and hold this great secret mantra of great victory."

The Blessed One replied, "So be it," and Śakra, lord of gods, listened respectfully to the Blessed One.

Thereupon the Blessed One at that moment proclaimed these words of the great knowledge-mantra, the Golden One:

Thus:

Oṃ hini hini, hili hili, mili mili, hili mili, nihi nihi, nihirapini, kāñcanāpati, lokāmate, bhute, bhukuṭamantra, adhikṛte, bede bede betamantra, adhikṛte, hana hana, hasa hasa, chindha chindha, bhindha bhindha, bhagavati, jaye bijaye, jambhani, stambhani, bandhani, mohani, amoghashaktidhāraṇi, gr̥hṇa gr̥hṇa, kāḍamamānasi, jambhaya jambhaya, bhañjaya bhañjaya, stambhaya stambhaya, bandhaya bandhaya, mohaya mohaya —

the illusions of gods, the illusions of nāgas, the illusions of yakṣas, the illusions of rākṣasas, the illusions of garuḍas, the illusions of gandharvas, the illusions of asuras, the illusions of kinnaras, the illusions of great serpents, the illusions of knowledge-mantra holders, the illusions of kings who are victorious accomplished knowledge-mantra holders, the illusions of ṛṣis, the illusions of all sentient knowledge-mantra holders, the illusions of elemental spirits — all illusions:

rala rala, rajja rajja, dhuma dhuma, dhudhuma, rāva rāva, rāvana, cakrāntan, granthani, hana hana —

sarva-vidyā śatrūṇāṃ stambhaya — paralyze all the knowledge-mantras of enemies. vāyuṃ stambhaya — paralyze the wind. sūryaṃ stambhaya — paralyze the sun. somaṃ stambhaya — paralyze the moon. varuṇaṃ stambhaya — paralyze Varuṇa. agniṃ stambhaya — paralyze fire. uddakaṃ dhiti dhiti — waters, hold, hold. dhāraṇī-pāśa-haste — O you who hold the dhāraṇī-noose in your hand. veṣṭaya pāśane — bind with the noose. All those who rise up against me, all enemies, all those who bear hatred and deep malice toward me, all who quarrel and do battle, all who wish me harm — hana hana, daha daha, paca paca, phaṃjaya phaṃjaya, jambhaya jambhaya, stambhaya stambhaya, bandhaya bandhaya, mohaya mohaya, mahāmohani — bhagavati svāhā. Protect, protect me from all fear and harm and every contagious disease — phaṭ svāhā.

O Kauśika, whatever son of good family or daughter of good family, king or great minister of a king, whoever recalls this golden knowledge-mantra — no fear from enemies will arise for that person. The armed forces of enemies will have no power over that person's following. Neither gods, nor nāgas, nor yakṣas, nor rākṣasas, nor gandharvas, nor asuras, nor garuḍas, nor kinnaras, nor knowledge-mantra holders, nor dākinīs will be able to bring about an untimely death for that person. Knowledge-mantras, secret mantras, and medicines will have no power over that person. The armed forces of enemies will have no power, and the armed forces of enemies will not be able to bring about that person's death. No weapon will have power over the body. No fire, water, poison, knowledge-mantra, secret mantra, or medicine will have power over the body.

Whatever evil is done, or caused to be done, or rejoiced in by another — that very evil will rebound upon its author. It will return to that very person.

O Kauśika, therefore a faithful monk or nun, layman or laywoman, son of good family or daughter of good family, who recites this knowledge-mantra seven times over water and anoints their own body with it — their body will be protected. Whoever desires to pass entirely beyond all fears, all harms, epidemic disease, every contagious illness, all knowledge-mantras, secret mantras, all medicines, and all sorcery should recall this golden knowledge-mantra. A king or royal minister who desires to defeat enemy forces and to subdue enemy troops should recall this golden knowledge-mantra. Reciting it seven times, one should tie a cord with seven knots and wear it, or recite it seven times over water and thereby protect oneself.

Write out the dhāraṇī of unobstructed passage through all fears in a text and carry it, or hang it around the neck. Write it out and fasten it to the tip of a victory banner, and upon entering battle one will emerge safe and well. By the power of this knowledge-mantra, one's inner circle of people, servants, and retinue will all pass through safely and well. Even those whose aims were unaccomplished will have them accomplished.

Whoever desires to shatter a knowledge-mantra should recite it seven times over a white cord and tie seven knots — whatever had been bound and ensnared will thereby be shattered and freed. Whoever desires to shatter an illusion should recite it seven times and scatter it upon the earth of a charnel ground, and the illusion's power will be shattered and freed. Whoever desires to silence an opponent during a debate should recite it seven times over a lump of clay and apply it — then all the speech and replies of every debater will be met and overcome. It should be read, it should be recited, it should be uttered — by the mere act of utterance all non-virtues whatsoever will be utterly pacified. Whatever was done by another and whatever was intended by another will return to that very person.

If one wears the cord or performs the self-protection with water, then upon that person's body, knowledge-mantras, secret mantras, and

all medicines whatsoever will have no power over it. Whatever was unaccomplished will become accomplished. And all the aims relating to that will come to be fulfilled.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, rejoiced and offered fervent praise to what the Blessed One had proclaimed.

The dhāraṇī called "The Noble Golden One" is complete.

This was translated and revised by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Dānaśīla together with the great editor-translator, the monk Yeshé Dé, and was then established in the new language and style.

Translator's Notes

- The location of the Blessed One at the opening is described as a place "like the sky," rendering the Tibetan idiom for an indeterminate celestial or sky-like dwelling; this is a somewhat unusual setting formula and may reflect a corrupt or abbreviated transmission of the original locative phrase.

The mantra syllables are transliterated diplomatically from the Tibetan phonetic rendering of Sanskrit; some syllables are onomatopoeic or purely esoteric and do not yield standard Sanskrit lexical meaning. "Bhañjaya" has been preferred over alternative vocalizations based on the Tibetan spelling.

The final lines of the passage constitute the beginning of the mantra's enumeration of illusions to be overcome, ending mid-sequence at "hana hana," indicating the passage provided is incomplete.

- The passage is a dhāraṇī text combining Sanskrit mantra syllables with Tibetan ritual instruction. The Sanskrit mantra portions have been transliterated as they stand; they are liturgical formulae not intended to be translated semantically. The phrase rendered "golden knowledge-mantra" reflects the Tibetan "gser can gyi rig sngags," a recurring epithet in this text for the dhāraṇī being taught. The final sentence breaks off mid-clause as it does in the source passage, indicating a continuation in the next folio.
- The colophon names the standard trio responsible for many canonical translations of the imperial and early post-imperial period: the Indian paṇḍitas Jinamitra and Dānaśīla, and the Tibetan lotsāwa Yeshé Dé. The phrase rendered "established in the new language and style" reflects the Tibetan skad gsar bcad, a technical colophon term indicating the text was revised in conformity with the standardised orthographic and terminological conventions introduced by the ninth-century royal edict on translation terminology.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.